



Smartwatch

Where health, design and intelligence meet

Smartwatches have matured from simple notification machines into powerful health companions, productivity tools, and personalised fitness trackers. This year's contenders pushed harder on battery life, smarter software, and more reliable health features. After testing them across daily use, workouts, sleep tracking and app ecosystems, three models stood out for their balance of intelligence, design and long-term reliability.

Zero1 Winner: Apple Watch Series 11

The Apple Watch Series 11 looks nearly identical to the Series 10, same slim design, same bright display, same fast performance. But under the hood, Apple has focused on things defining daily experiences: durability, battery life, and health features.

The new scratch-resistant glass cover makes a noticeable difference for everyday wear, especially for users who train outdoors or simply tend to bump their wrists against surfaces. The bigger upgrade is battery life, now stretching close to two days, which finally makes sleep tracking and alarms more practical without that constant low-battery anxiety. Optional 5G support improves connectivity for those using cellular models, and fast charging remains one of the best in the category.

watchOS 26 adds intelligence with the new Sleep Score that offers meaningful insights, while FDA-approved hypertension notifications are a good addition for at-risk users. Workout Buddy, a smart, AI-powered coach, is surprisingly engaging.

The Series 11 may not be radically different, but it's the most polished, reliable, and complete smartwatch you can buy today, especially if you're pairing it with an iPhone.



Apple Watch Series 11
Price: ₹46,900

Runner-up: Samsung Galaxy Watch8 Classic

Samsung holds its own with the Galaxy Watch8 Classic, which continues its blend of premium design and deep health tracking. The rotating bezel remains a joy to use, and Samsung's health suite delivers actionable insights across workouts, heart rate monitoring, and sleep tracking. Wear OS runs smoothly and Galaxy AI features coupled with Google Gemini add intelligent touches to workouts and daily analytics.

While the Watch8 Classic offers excellent performance and arguably the most stylish hardware of the lot, battery life still lags behind some competitors, and certain features work best, or only with Samsung phones. It's a superb Android smartwatch, but it stops just short of Apple's all-round consistency.



Samsung Galaxy Watch8 Classic
Price: ₹46,999

Best Buy: Amazfit Balance 2

Amazfit continues to dominate the value segment, and the Balance 2 offers a long battery life, solid build quality, and impressively detailed health tracking at a price that undercuts most mainstream brands. Zepp OS remains lightweight but capable, offering accurate GPS performance, SpO2 tracking, stress metrics, and a refined suite of fitness tools.

The Balance 2 stands out with a week-long battery life so you can truly use it as a 24x7 health companion without worrying. It's reliable, comfortable for all-day wear, and includes AI-powered wellness insights that feel genuinely actionable.

If you want a capable smartwatch without premium pricing, the Amazfit Balance 2 is easily the smartest purchase.

— Siddharth Chauhan | editor@digit.in



Amazfit Balance 2
Price: ₹24,999